

Leica X-U

Taking your camera on an adventure trip can be risky since most of the point and shoot cameras are fragile and surely won't survive a drop. Hence, you turn towards action cameras but they don't offer the kind of quality you would want in your photos. Leica is filling up the void with their X-U that will fulfill all your adventure photography requirements. Capable of taking photos underwater (up to 15 metres), the camera is shock-resistant, dust-sealed and shatterproof, making it an ideal companion on an expedition out in the wilderness. The X series of cameras from Leica packs the 16.5 MP APS-C CMOS sensor, combined with their premium Summilux 23mm f/1.7 ASPH lens. The same has been carried on in the X-U, offering superior quality photos while maintaining the rigidity for rough usage. To ensure that the camera withstands the strong conditions it's going to be exposed to, the X-U has a non-slip body and a toughened monitor screen cover. The camera is also capable of shooting videos in 1920x1080 and 1280x720 at 30 frames per second. It's priced at around ₹2.3 lakhs.



SPECIFICATIONS

Lens: Leica Summilux 23mm f/1.7 ASPH. | **Sensor:** 16.5 MP APS-C CMOS | **ISO:** Up to 12500 | **Shutter Speed:** 30 to 1/2000 sec | **Screen:** 3-inch TFT LCD | **Storage:** SD/SDHC/SDXC memory cards | **Weight:** 600 g

Arcaboard

The movie Back To The Future predicted that by 2015 kids would be gliding across town on hoverboards. It's 2016 and all we've got are prototypes and wheeled boards trying to pass off as hoverboards. The latter should stop masquerading as the real thing, immediately. Among the prototypes making the rounds on the internet, most of them are based on the concept of magnetic levitation, making it restrictive to hover above magnetic material only. Arcaboard is another attempt at perfecting this nascent technology and yes, it actually hovers. There's no fancy physics involved here but rather a simple function of upward thrust. The lift is generated by 36 electric fans outputting a combined 272 bhp. Such high consumption drastically cuts down on the operational time so you won't be able to hover for more than six minutes. It further reduces to a mere three minutes if you're heavier since it switches to the "Enhanced Thrust Version" to support the extra weight. As disappointing as this might sound, it takes about six hours to charge and the company gives the impatient ones an option to buy the ArcaDock accessory to boost the charging speed in under 35 minutes. The Arcaboard will let you hover at a software-limited maximum speed of 20 kmph.



NUA Robotics Suitcase

You might have always wanted someone like R2-D2 following you around wherever you go. Since we have a long way to go until we build astrodroids, the NUA Robotics Suitcase will have to do for now. The suitcase connects to your phone using Bluetooth and gives you full control through an app. With the tap of a button, the suitcase will start following you, by tracking your location (or rather your phone's location). The proximity detection hardware will ensure that it avoids any kind of obstacle coming in its way and figures out an alternate route. Manually pulling the suitcase will charge the battery on the go and the battery pack inside will let you charge mobile devices such as smartphones, tablets, laptops etc., from the suitcase as well. Still just a prototype, we can't blame them for not putting a price tag on it yet.